Hospital preparation checklist

FIRST SIGNS | PREPARING FOR YOUR CHILD'S ADMISSION

Hospital-specific pre-operative instructions always take priority. Use this list to organise, not to instruct.

Ask the treating team before admission

- [ ] What should we bring?
- [ ] What should the child eat or drink before admission?
- [ ] Which medicines or supplements should be discussed?
- [ ] How long should we expect to be in hospital?
- [ ] Who will be the main surgical and paediatric contacts?
- [ ] What should we expect immediately after surgery?
- [ ] What signs after discharge should prompt an urgent call?
- [ ] When is the first follow-up?
- [ ] How will blood be arranged if needed; should we arrange donors in advance?

The folder: documents to carry

- [ ] Referral papers
- [ ] Scan reports and the actual images
- [ ] Blood-test reports, if requested by the treating team
- [ ] Medication information
- [ ] Insurance documents, scheme cards (PM-JAY, state scheme, CGHS) and ID proofs
- [ ] Emergency contact numbers
- [ ] Your written questions for the medical team

Practical items for the stay

- [ ] Feeding items your child is used to
- [ ] A comfort object; front-opening clothes for easy dressing
- [ ] Phone chargers; small cash; a notebook for instructions
- [ ] A plan for who stays which night, so both parents get rest
- [ ] Care arrangements for siblings at home

For families travelling to another city

- [ ] Written cost estimate received before travel
- [ ] Stay booked near the hospital for after discharge, if advised
- [ ] Return-journey plan discussed with the team (when is it safe to travel?)

> **Do not copy another family's medication, fasting, wound-care or recovery instructions.** Follow the instructions given by your own treating team.

Notes

> First Signs provides general educational information. It does not diagnose or treat, and it does not replace a consultation with a qualified medical professional. Draft document, pending medical review.